In those tense days of the cold war, the US and the Soviet Union played out their relationship via hostile interventions in countries that could easily be manoeuvered. A secret note said:

Any balanced account of the events in the last decade would concede that the Soviet Union took advantage of the post Vietnam political problems in the US to make a series of moves, particularly in Africa and Asia, which gave them major political advantages. Yet to see the Soviet hand in all anti-American developments, whether in Africa, South East Asia or Central America, is a deliberately simplistic analysis of International reality. The Ethiopian revolution or the defeat of the Portuguese colonialism in Southern Africa were determined more by the indigenous developments in those countries than by Soviet instigation. The major question, now, is whether and how long the mood of confrontation, which has produced the largest US defence budget in history, would last. It is argued, not without reason, that the internal logic of US President Ronald Reagan's economic policies

would eventually defeat the very objective of these policies. While the ability of the Soviet society to accept hardships in the face of external threats is far superior to that of the US, this is to an extent compensated by the limited resources which the Soviet economy would be able to muster as against that of the United States. Thus is the balance between the relative strength of the two superpowers' economies, which is compensated by their inverse ability to make sacrifices, to determine the course of international events in the decade. On both sides there have been groups, which have argued publicly against a return to the limited understanding of the early 70s. Yet it would be reasonable to expect that for all the inherent contradictions